



Democrats weigh a stand on spending

To protest sweeping cuts, some say they will not help avert a shutdown

BY MARIANA ALFARO

Some Democrats warned they will not cooperate with Republicans in reaching a government funding deal because of their objections to President Donald Trump's and Elon Musk's unilateral actions to radically downsize the federal government.

At least one Democrat did so clearly Sunday as Republicans struggle to craft a compromise that would continue government spending after March 14.

Republicans have in the past few years struggled to meet funding deadlines because of strenuous opposition from far-right lawmakers. Republicans have had to repeatedly turn to Democrats for help.

"Look, if we have to take steps to be able to hold them accountable, use the leverage that we have to force it, I cannot support efforts that will continue this lawlessness that we're seeing when it comes to this administration's actions," Sen. Andy Kim (D-New Jersey) said on NBC News's "Meet the Press." "And for us to be able to support government funding in that way only for them to turn it around to dismantle the government, that is not something that should be allowed."

"This is on them," Kim continued, referring to Republicans.

Kim is one of several Democratic senators who have fiercely protested the effective shutdown of the U.S. Agency for International Development after Trump ordered a foreign aid freeze and Musk's U.S. DOGE Service showed up at the agency's headquarters. Kim and other Democrats have said the unilateral gutting of USAID is unconstitutional because it was created by Congress, and warn the action will serve as a playbook for other actions that they contend are illegal.

"I've worked through multiple government shutdowns; I would be the last person to want to get to that stage," Kim said. "But we are at a point where we are basically on the cusp of a consti-

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A8

Big and easy in New Orleans



JAMIE SQUIRE/GETTY IMAGES

Coach Nick Sirianni hoists the Lombardi Trophy next to quarterback Jalen Hurts after the Philadelphia Eagles' 40-22 win over the Kansas City Chiefs in Super Bowl LIX on Sunday night in New Orleans. Philadelphia claimed its second NFL title in eight years — and denied Kansas City a third straight championship. **More in Sports, D1**

Guantánamo plan could be a 'legal black hole'

Lawyers call for migrants sent there to be allowed access to counsel

BY SILVIA FOSTER-FRAU

Their names have not been released. Their exact crimes are unknown. The more than three dozen immigrants being held at Guantánamo Bay Naval Base in Cuba have entered what lawyers are calling a "legal black hole."

Nearly a week ago, the Trump administration flew the first migrants from Fort Bliss, Texas, to Guantánamo Bay. The officials said the detainees were "dangerous criminals," "the worst of the worst" and alleged members of a violent Venezuelan gang, and are

holding them in a prison on the U.S. naval base created for suspected terrorists after Sept. 11, 2001. But administration officials have released almost no other information.

The unusual and hasty movement of detainees to the military prison with a history of accusations of human rights violations comes as President Donald Trump attempts to fulfill a campaign promise to aggressively increase the number of immigration arrests and deportations. U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement detention facilities in the United States have quickly filled, officials say, and Trump has ordered the construction of detention space for as many as 30,000 migrants at Guantánamo.

In Guantánamo, most of those migrants are expected to live in

SEE MIGRANTS ON A6

Musk's ex-staff warn of long hours and firings

His other ventures hint at what may be in store for federal workers

BY PRANSHU VERMA, TRISHA THADANI AND FAIZ SIDDIQUI

Longtime Twitter employee Eric Frohnhoefer was accused to the Silicon Valley ethos of respectful disagreement. So when his new boss, Elon Musk, seemed to misidentify why the social media site was running slowly, Frohnhoefer took to the platform to correct the company's CEO.

Musk's reaction was swift and definitive. The day after their online disagreement, Frohnhoe-

fer's computer access was shut off and Musk informed his hundreds of millions of followers of Frohnhoefer's fate. "He's fired," Musk wrote in a now-deleted tweet.

"I'd been laid off before this, but what's different was the lack of communication and the lack of professionalism," Frohnhoefer said in an interview with The Washington Post.

The incident illustrates Musk's boundary-pushing leadership style that he has deployed at his companies, including Tesla, SpaceX and Twitter, now X. But now the billionaire — recast as a "special government employee" at the U.S. DOGE Service — is bringing his unorthodox methods to Washington, where they are clashing with the traditionally staid and steady federal workforce.

SEE MUSK ON A18

Jordan wary of Trump's proposal

FEARS OF ECONOMIC DESTABILIZATION

King Abdullah to meet with president Tuesday

BY CLAIRE PARKER

AMMAN, JORDAN — President Donald Trump's proposal to remove all Palestinians from Gaza and send them to nearby countries has stoked widespread anger in this small Arab monarchy, a longtime U.S. ally that is already home to millions of Palestinian refugees — and where experts say a new influx of displaced people would destabilize the country.

Trump has said Egypt and Jordan should take in more Palestinians, describing the Gaza Strip as unlivable after 16 months of war. He announced last week that the United States would "take over" the territory and turn it into the "Riviera" of the Middle East. But Jordan, whose leader King Abdullah II will meet the president in Washington on Tuesday, has long made its position clear: The displacement of Palestinians to the Hashemite kingdom is a red line.

The push by Trump has turbocharged a reckoning over Jordan's reliance on U.S. aid and revived existential questions about the country's identity and political future, at a time of simmering popular dissatisfaction with the king. Jordan is highly dependent on both U.S. military and economic assistance, the latter of which is transferred directly to the state to prop up its budget — and Trump has

SEE JORDAN ON A10

Plan riles newly won voters in Michigan

BY NATALIE ALLISON

DEARBORN, MICH. — The half-dozen Lebanese American retirees sat socializing in the same spot they do every afternoon: the mall sofas on the ground floor of Fairlane Town Center.

Ali Hammoud, 77, was still incensed over what President Donald Trump had said days earlier about the United States taking control of the Gaza Strip, moving out its remaining residents and facilitating its redevelopment as the "Riviera of the Middle East." Hammoud was among the longtime Democrats who helped Trump win this heavily Arab American city outside Detroit, supporting him for the first time in November over their dissatisfaction with Joe Biden and Kamala Harris's support for continued aid to Israel.

Now, some Arab American voters here who helped Trump win back Michigan are wondering whether they were duped by his promises to bring a swift end to the war that has left Gaza decimated.

"Instead of helping them in

SEE GAZA ON A11

U.S. intervention: Trump's idea for Gaza is not a complete outlier. **A14**

Letters of longing and sorrow fill Japan's 'Missing Post Office'



HIROKI KOBAYASHI FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A visitor reads a letter in the "Missing Post Office" on Japan's Awashima Island in August. The post office destination came to be after a 2013 exhibit showcasing letters attracted thousands.

Building houses more than 60,000 pieces of mail, with many containing messages to those lost

BY MICHELLE YE HEE LEE, JULIA MIO INUMA, HIROKI KOBAYASHI AND YUTAO CHEN

AWASHIMA ISLAND, JAPAN — There are two post offices on this remote Japanese island of 150 or so residents. Only one delivers mail to the living.

The other hasn't been officially operational in three decades. Instead, the "Missing Post Office" is a repository for 60,000-plus pieces of mail: letters, birthday cards and New Year's greetings sent from all over Japan to those with no forwarding address. Lost friends and pets; past and future selves; and, most frequently, the dead.

It is the destination for expressions of sorrow, hope and longing that have nowhere else to go. Messages that bring momentary relief and, in the case of the dead, serve as a connection between

our world and theirs, even if the piece of paper can be held only in ours.

The Missing Post Office is on the island of Awashima, one of thousands in the Seto Inland Sea, which sits between Japan's main southern islands.

Until the 1990s, Awashima had a flourishing port and most islanders were long-distance sailors. Its post office, with a telegram service, was once the only place for families to connect with their loved ones at sea. But in 1991, when the post office closed and services moved, the building was abandoned, like many others in remote areas of Japan with declining populations.

SEE LETTERS ON A13

IN THE NEWS

A more aggressive approach The Trump administration has taken a hostile tone with some faith-based groups that work with immigrants and the needy. **A3**

Voting crackdown Eligible voters could be affected as the GOP takes aim at noncitizen voting — an extremely rare problem. **A2**

THE NATION The Trump administration eliminated teams that fight foreign election interference. **A4**
Kristi L. Noem said she would recommend President Donald Trump "get rid" of FEMA. **A7**

THE WORLD Dire economic woes threaten to undermine the new government in Syria, which is facing a suspension of Iranian oil supplies and Western sanctions imposed during the Assad era. **A9**

THE ECONOMY T-Mobile and Starlink's satellite messaging service will be free to use until July. Here's what to know. **A15**

THE REGION A beloved equestrian facility in the District's Rock Creek Park could close because of financial challenges. **B1**

Pregnant asylum seekers at the center of a lawsuit against the Trump administration's order targeting birthright citizenship share their stories. **B1**
A Capitol rioter wants a pardon to cover his conviction in a 2022 plot to kill FBI agents who investigated him. **B1**

STYLE As the Oscars voting window looms, the campaign of "Emilia Pérez" has imploded. How did it get this bad? **C1**
Calvin Klein's show during New York Fashion Week, its first in several years, was an ode to the office siren trend. **C1**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54123

